

The Story of Glintjaw

A Born Good Side Story

*Eight hundred years before Elias set foot in Tetherpoint Academy,
a worthless little chest changed the world forever.*

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Chapter One

The Incubation of Greed

Era: 4 B.C.A. (Before the Containment Architecture) | Location: Bedlam Box — The Eastern Incubation Vaults

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The world was younger then. Before the Wizards Emporium. Before the laws that kept monsters in their place. Before anyone believed the world could ever be safe.

Maelora did not care for peace. She was the God of Chaos, and when the world grew quiet she made something that screamed. She had filled the earth with beasts because she wanted to see what they would do. Some burned. Some poisoned. Some tore mountains apart. Most died quickly. That never bothered her. Failure was only another experiment.

Deep beneath the oldest mountains lay Bedlam Box. The place breathed like something alive. Stone sweated. The walls shifted. Thousands of living sacs hung from the ceiling, each waiting to birth another horror.

Maelora walked among them. Most disappointed her. Then she stopped before a small vault. Inside sat a mimic. It looked like an ordinary chest. Cheap wood. Rusted hinges. Nothing about it was remarkable. Only the strange crystal where its lock should have been watched her as she watched it.

She sighed. "Pathetic."

The chest snapped shut.

She raised one hand. The wheel of affinity turned. Fire. Shadow. Death. Blood. Storm. Madness. Thousands of possibilities spun past before the wheel settled.

She frowned. Then she smiled. "Well."

The mimic stared at the enchanted trinket hanging from her sleeve. The air bent. The ornament tore free and flew straight into its mouth. The little creature clamped down as if the world might steal it back.

Maelora stared. "You little thief."

Then she laughed. The mountain shook with it. Demons fell to their knees. The mimic never looked away from its prize.

"So that's what you are." She crouched beside it. "Glintjaw."

The name fit. Gold appeared across its back teeth. Worthless little caps that shone brighter than they had any right to. The mimic rattled with delight. Its lid clicked again and again like coins spilling across a table. It loved treasure more than food. More than life.

Maelora stood. "Go hoard."

She left the vault. Behind her came a tapping sound. She looked back. The mimic bounced awkwardly across the stone floor after something. Her crystal mallet. It was nothing special to her. Just a tool used to shape monster cores. To Glintjaw it was everything.

He leaped. Missed. Hit the floor. Got back up. Jumped again. Again. Again.

She watched him fail until she grew curious. Finally she lowered the mallet. Glintjaw seized it with both jaws and every leg he had. He pulled with all his strength. The hammer did not move.

She reached down and took it back. "No."

The mimic froze. Then it bit her. Its teeth sank into the finger of the God of Chaos. Silence spread through the vault. No creature had ever done such a thing.

Maelora looked at the bite. Then she laughed harder than before. "You fearless little bastard."

Glintjaw growled around her finger. He did not let go. She held him up and studied him. He was tiny. Weak. Greedy. He had no fear at all.

She offered him the mallet again. This time she let him keep it. He wrapped every limb around the crystal head and refused to let go.

She opened a tear in the world. Beyond it waited a forgotten cave where travelers sometimes searched for easy riches. She tossed him through. He disappeared into the darkness with the hammer locked against his chest. The portal began to close.

Maelora smiled. "Wait there, little Glintjaw. One day someone richer than you will come."

The rift sealed. She never imagined she had just armed the greediest creature in creation.

Glintjaw settled into the dark with his first treasure. It would never be enough.

Chapter Two

The First Hoard

Location: The Caverns of Light

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The Caverns of Light had no need for the sun. Crystal veins climbed every wall, bathing the cavern in pale blue and white. Pools reflected the glow until it seemed the whole world shimmered.

Glintjaw noticed none of it. He sat in the middle of the cavern with the crystal mallet clutched against his chest. Every few moments he licked it, then hugged it tighter. It was his. Nothing else mattered.

A faint pulse traveled through the hammer. Glintjaw froze. The crystal began to fade. He bit down harder. The handle slipped through his teeth like mist. "No." The head disappeared next. He shook it violently. The weapon continued dissolving.

Panic seized him. He bounced across the cavern, slamming into crystal pillars. He snapped wildly at empty air. His little wooden body rattled with desperate fury. The hammer was gone.

Glintjaw shrieked. The echo carried through the cavern.

Three adventurers rounded the bend. A frost mage. A warrior. A holy priest. All wore the bronze crest of beginner adventurers.

"Did you hear that?" the priest asked.

The warrior pointed. "A mimic."

The mage laughed. "Level one."

Glintjaw looked up. The warrior meant nothing. The priest meant nothing. Then he saw the mage. Two enchanted rings. A glowing orb floating beside her shoulder. Beautiful. Mine.

The mimic charged.

The warrior stepped forward and buried his sword into Glintjaw's lid. Wood splintered. Health dropped. The priest smirked. "That was easy."

A bolt of frost struck next. Ice exploded across Glintjaw's body. Another slash. Another spell. His health plummeted. Seventy percent. Fifty. Thirty.

The mage prepared another Frost Bolt. "Finish it."

The spell struck. Twenty-five percent.

The world stopped.

The frost surrounding Glintjaw did not melt. It flowed. Blue mana streamed into the center of his body. The adventurers stared. "What..."

The mage fired another Frost Bolt. Instead of exploding, the spell vanished into Glintjaw. Inside his wooden frame, something formed. A crystal handle. Then a head. Not the old hammer. A new one. Forged from frost itself. It glowed with cold blue light.

Glintjaw wrapped his limbs around it. Mine.

The mage stumbled backward. "Stop casting!"

Too late. The third Frost Bolt disappeared into the hammer. Its glow intensified. Cold rolled across the cavern floor.

Glintjaw swung. He had no technique. No skill. Only greed. The hammer slammed into the stone. The cavern erupted. Frozen mana exploded outward in every direction. Crystal shards and icy wind engulfed the party.

The warrior froze first. The priest reached for a spell that never came. The mage's eyes widened as ice crawled over her face. Three statues stood before Glintjaw.

He bounced toward the nearest. Swing. The warrior shattered into glittering fragments. Swing. The priest exploded into frozen dust. Swing. The mage broke apart last.

Two objects clattered onto the stone. A glowing ring. A floating frost orb.

Glintjaw's crystal eye widened. Treasure.

He pounced. The ring dissolved into his body. The orb followed. Mana rushed through his wooden frame.

Glintjaw looked around the empty cavern. No more treasure. He hugged his glowing hammer. Then he began hopping deeper into the darkness. There would be shinier things ahead.

Chapter Three

The Waiting Trap

Location: The Caverns of Light — Side Passage

Two brilliant, azure windows flashed in rapid succession before Glintjaw's central crystal eye, cutting through the dim ambient twilight of the cavern.

The sudden influx of cognitive clarity felt entirely foreign, almost uncomfortable. Thoughts that had previously existed only as base, primal urges — mine, shiny, eat, hide — suddenly organized themselves into something sharp, linear, and calculating. The fog of low-tier monstrosity receded. Glintjaw sat completely still on the damp stone floor, deliberately focusing his intent until a detailed status window manifested in his field of vision.

With enhanced intelligence came a brand-new instinct. If absorbing raw magic was the catalyst that made him smarter, faster, and more resilient, then wandering the tunnels aimlessly was an inefficient waste of energy. Strategy replaced impulse. He needed to position himself where the magic would inevitably come to him.

Sprouting six stubby, splintered wooden legs from his underbelly, Glintjaw scuttled with quiet purpose toward a narrow, shadow-drenched side passage. He found a recessed alcove near a cluster of dormant mana crystals. With a wet, shifting sound of creaking wood and morphing iron, he tucked his appendages beneath his chassis, settling into the perfect, pristine shape of an abandoned, iron-banded treasure chest. Inside his extradimensional void pocket, his adhesive tongue curled tightly around the handle of his heavy mallet, waiting.

Minutes stretched into an hour. Then, the rhythmic crackle and hum of localized lightning echoed down the main corridor.

An elven male shaman, bearing the distinct, proud stance of a seasoned Level 6 adventurer, strode into the cavern. Three miniature elemental totems floated in a slow orbit around his shoulders, humming with defensive magic. He was systematically clearing the sector, farming rare reagents from the cavern's lesser lightning elementals. Blue sparks danced merrily along his leather bracers as he used a curved dagger to harvest glowing crystal clusters and rare, static-infused herbs from the rock faces.

Glintjaw did not breathe. He did not twitch. He suppressed the ambient glow of his crystal eye, appearing as nothing more than a forgotten reward left behind by a previous dungeon tier.

The shaman turned the corner, his eyes lighting up instantly as they locked onto the lone chest resting innocently against the far wall.

"Finally," the elf muttered to himself, a greedy grin breaking across his sharp features. "Something actually worth opening in this dump."

He sheathed his harvesting dagger and approached with unhurried confidence, entirely misreading the lack of traps on the exterior. The very instant his leather-gloved fingers wrapped around the iron latch of the lid, Glintjaw's trap sprung.

The lid flew open, revealing rows of jagged, crystalline fangs. With a sickening crunch of fracturing bone, Glintjaw's jaws snapped shut entirely around the shaman's right forearm. The elf let out a choked gasp of shock, attempting to yank his limb back, but the mimic's grip was absolute. With a brutal twist of his wooden chassis, Glintjaw tore the arm completely free at the elbow in a heavy spray of crimson blood.

The shaman screamed — a high, agonizing sound that echoed off the cavern walls. Driven by pure survival instinct, he triggered his instant-cast spells, unleashing a localized Frost Burst closely followed by a roaring Flame Burst. Chilling frost and searing, chaotic fire slammed directly into Glintjaw's face.

The mimic rocked backward but immediately retaliated. Channeling his newly refined mana, he spat a piercing Frost Bolt directly into the elf's exposed chest. Before the shaman could recover his footing, Glintjaw triggered Freeze, locking the adventurer's legs in a thick, crystalline block of magical ice, buying himself a precious second of tactical dominance.

Enraged, pale from blood loss, and panicking, the shaman used his remaining hand to draw a heavy mace, instantly enchanting it with Flametongue Weapon. The weapon's iron head burst into violent, roaring flames. With desperate, furious strength, he brought the heavy mace down in a sequence of crushing, crackling blows against Glintjaw's wooden lid.

The structural integrity of the mimic's body groaned under the assault. His health bar began to plummet rapidly.

Health: 70%... 40%... 20%...

Just as the fatal blow was descending, Glintjaw's primary defensive passive kicked in: Magical Absorption (Level 1) activated.

Suddenly, the dynamic of the fight shifted completely. Every heavy strike from the flaming mace and every stray bolt of residual lightning the desperate shaman hurled no longer deducted health from Glintjaw's pool. Instead, the raw elemental energy was redirected inward, feeding directly into the Incubation Mallet resting within his void pocket. The mallet's crystal head began to glow with blinding intensity, cycling through violent colors — deep electric blue, blinding orange, and finally, a stable, white-hot brilliance.

When the hammer could physically hold no more kinetic and magical energy, Glintjaw unhinged his jaw and swung the weapon outward with all the force his attribute points could muster.

A massive, unstable Pyroblast erupted from the head of the mallet, slamming point-blank into the shaman's chest. The elf barely had time to shriek before the concentrated explosion of fire consumed him entirely. The roaring inferno illuminated the entire side passage, burning the adventurer alive within seconds until nothing remained but blackened soot, charred bone fragments, and scattered, glowing reagents.

The silence of the cave returned. Glintjaw hopped forward on his stubby legs, sniffing the ashes.

A fine silk robe, remarkably preserved at the edges and heavily trimmed with intricate, glowing elemental runes, lay among the debris. Glintjaw pounced on it, dragging the fabric into his maw, dissolving the magical threads directly into his core.

Glintjaw closed his lid tightly, hugging his now comfortably warm, humming mallet to his internal core. He rattled his iron hinges with genuine, bubbling delight. The dark cavern didn't seem so hostile anymore. In fact, it felt a little brighter.

He settled back into his alcove, shifting his form back into the unassuming shape of a treasure chest. There would be more adventurers. There were always more.

Chapter Four

The Core Fixation

Location: The Deep Caverns

For six days the cavern lay in a silence that had weight to it, the kind of silence that comes before something, not after. Glintjaw did not like it.

He dragged his splintered frame through the muck on six stubby legs that did not yet move as one. He had grown wiser in his exile, and wisdom had taught him this much: he was being cheated. From the high tunnels came the voices of men, carried down on currents of cold air the way all sound traveled in that mountain, faint and strange. They spoke of disappearances. They spoke of a shaman who would not wake again. Fear had made them cautious, and caution kept them to the safe paths, far from his reach.

This did not sit well with him. He had no use for their fear, only for the bright metal they wore and the rings that hummed faintly with old power, the kind of treasure that made a wooden thing feel, for a moment, like something more than wood. But the bearers of such treasure no longer came his way.

So it fell to the old hunger to decide his course. That is the way of it, when one is a monster. One eats, or one does not.



He felt the slimes before he found them—a faint vibration through the stone, the only sense a mimic truly trusts, for he had no nose to catch a scent on and no lungs to draw breath through. Three of them moved along the crystal vein in a slow procession, blind and earless things, green and glistening, going nowhere in particular with great purpose.

Glintjaw flattened himself against the cold floor. Wood does not breathe, and a thing that does not breathe can be very patient. He let his lid hang open the width of a finger, the way driftwood gapes after the river has finished with it and moved on to other business.

The lead slime came up close and pressed its formless face against his hinge.

He held still.

It pressed again, leaving behind a smear of something sour and faintly rotten.

Then his jaw came open.

It happened the way such things happen, swift after a long patience. He caught the first across its middle. The other two scattered, after their fashion, which was not scattering so much as a slow and

foolish wobbling in two directions. He went left. That one tried the wall, and walls, as it turned out, do not answer the prayers of slimes; it slid back down into his waiting mouth as if delivered there.

The third he ran down properly, though properly is a generous word for any pursuit involving a slime. It left a shining trail on the stone, and twice he lost his footing chasing it, his new legs unlearned in such matters. He found the rhythm by the third stride—four legs for purchase, two trailing for balance, the way a young hound has not yet made peace with its own tail. He ran the creature into a dead end of stone, where it pulsed once against the rock as if it understood, in whatever dim way a slime understands anything, that the road had ended.

That one he ate slowly, and savored it.

The first two burned on the way down, a low and climbing heat that filled the dark cavity where his stomach ought to have been but was not, for he had something stranger in its place, a void-cavity that simply made things disappear into purpose. He swallowed through the burning, as he always did. When it passed, something in him had been remade, quietly, the way a key turns at last in a lock long given up for rusted shut.

He worked his jaw and tasted the last of it on whatever served him for a tongue. Some new chamber had opened in him to hold it.



The needleclaws were another matter entirely.

He came upon their nest by misfortune more than craft, a fissure choked with old webbing where dozens of them lay packed close, legs folded like switchblades against their black and segmented bodies. He set a foot down wrong, and the whole nest woke at once, as one creature with many wills.

They did not scatter as the slimes had scattered. They had the bearing of soldiers who had done this before. They came around him in a ring, cutting off every path before he had even marked the first sting. He snapped at the nearest and found only air. Three more ran their blade-legs down a seam in his shell while his jaw was still closing on nothing.

The pain came bright and many, not the long dull ruin the lightning would bring him later, but a hundred small and precise hurts opening together in the grain of his wood. He made a sound meant to be a roar that came out instead as splitting timber. He struck out in every direction and struck nothing.

There was a pattern in it, and he felt the shape of the pattern before he understood it. Some came low, for the joints of his legs. Some dropped from above, hunting the hinge of his lid. A third group held back and watched, patient as judges, waiting for him to commit his weight one way so the rest might open him from the other.

He stopped trying to bite all of them at once.

He chose one—a quick one, plainly the one the others followed, circling his back left leg with the easy confidence of long practice. He let two more cuts land while he watched only this one. He set the pain aside, the way a man sets aside a debt he intends to collect on later. When the point-runner

finally committed, he struck for the place it occupied.

It was not there when his jaw arrived.

He struck again. It was not there a second time either.

The third time he did not aim for where the creature was, nor even for where it was going, but for where it would believe he must strike next, gambling that two failures had taught it to expect a third in the same vein. The gamble held. His jaw closed on the place its own leg carried it, faster than the small mind behind that leg could revise its plan.

He crushed it between his teeth.

What remained had no one left to follow, and their order broke apart into something honest and small—plain fear, every creature now only for itself. That, he understood completely. He stopped thinking and gave himself over to the work of claw and jaw and the sheer ruined weight of his own body, until the fissure ran black with paste and fell quiet once more. He came to know their anatomy in the only way that mattered to him: by feel, by where the joints surrendered, by which parts of them screamed loudest before they stopped.

When it was finished, his shell looked like timber that had survived flood and fire in the same season. He counted four gouges deep enough to bare the iron banding beneath.

New claws rose from his underbelly, heavy and calcified, made for one purpose only. He drove them into the stone and felt them answer him, and was glad, in his way, for the weight of what he was becoming.



But a new hunger was stirring now, and it was worse than the old one. It pulled at him from somewhere deep in the bones of the mountain, a frequency that set the crystal mallet in his void pocket burning white and restless against whatever passed for his will. He left the hunting grounds he had only just begun to call his own and went down, down into the sealed places where the air tasted of sulfur and something that was not quite lightning yet.

He came at last into a vast chamber at the very root of the mountain. A dais of plain stone stood at its center, and over the dais, turning slowly, hung the thing he had come for.

The Dungeon CoreMagical ObjectA living magical anchor that binds monsters to subterranean Dungeons. The specific core stolen by the Mimic was a direct vessel for Maelora.→ Read moreDungeon Core.

It spun in its own light, blue shading into white and back again, holding more raw power than the whole mountain above it had any right to claim. To Glintjaw's single eye it was not beautiful. It was the only hoard worth the name. It was every cheap and stolen trinket he had ever swallowed, made small and shameful by comparison. Mine, he thought, and there was no thought after that one, only the wanting.

He launched himself across the chamber, jaw thrown wide, meaning to swallow the bright center of the world whole.

The core had other intentions.

White fire took him before his teeth came near it, tearing through his low and unworthy Magical Absorption Passive Ability — Mimic Redirects incoming magical energy into the Incubation Mallet, charging it for devastating counterattacks. → Read more Magical Absorption as though no such ward existed at all. It went through shell and timber both, and the sound of it was the largest sound he had ever known, and then he was in the air, and then he was not.

He met the far wall hard enough to feel something give way inside him that had not given way before.

The chamber fell silent again. Glintjaw lay on his side in the dust. His once-fine wood had gone black and scorched through, his iron hinges twisted and still smoking faintly. His stats flickered before his eye like a lamp that could not decide whether to stay lit. The hurt was a thing entire, beyond any hurt he had yet carried.

He rose anyway. Slowly. One leg, and then the next, and then the rest in their turn. He shook the last of the static from his eye and looked again to the center of the room, where the core spun on, untroubled, cold, and pleased with itself in the manner of things that have never once been beaten.

He was not afraid. The fire had burned the fear from him along with everything softer than fear. What remained was simpler, and colder, and would not be put down. It was only the wanting now, and the wanting did not tire.

He would return to the dark tunnels. He would hunt the small and the foolish, and wait for the bold ones to bring him their swords and their treasures, as they always did, sooner or later. He would grow heavy. He would grow hard to kill, harder than anything in this mountain had ever needed to be. And then, when he had grown enough, he would come back down to this room and try the core again.

He meant to crack it open. He meant to eat the whole mountain doing it.